

1938, July 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the type written original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

better as he came to dinner with us and, afterwards, put on his shoes and "shot us over" to St. Paul.

Next evening (Saturday), Dean Conley brought us via Hudson and River Falls to Prescott, where we met some old friends who took us to the Rectory, where they were preparing for the Jubilee celebration next day. The Rev. Pastor from St. Mary's, Big River, met us there and took Fr. M. J. and myself out with him to offer Holy Mass next morning. Fr. Maurice said the first Mass --6:30, and gave a touching little sermon. The attendance was good, and quite a few Holy Communions.

The same old St. Mary's, beautiful and well kept as ever, has been built out on both sides since we were there sixty years back, so that it would nicely accommodate probably eight hundred. The Rev. Pastor came back from his mission and in a very short time we were in Prescott, vesting for the Solemn Mass, His Excellency, Bishop Griffen, attending with his chaplain and a record congregation. Among these, of course, were many old friends, and, more especially, children and grandchildren of such. Quite a number of the Manions, and relatives, came to greet us after services, and the senior of them all--the 93 year old Wm. Betsel. Mrs. Betsel was 87 and a blind invalid. She seemed quite appreciative of our visit and blessings. You remember "Bill Betsel" who always drove the horses in threshing time.

Besides visiting the Betsels, we went over and said the rosary at a certain Bowers home, whose oldest was laid out awaiting burial -drowned in Chicago a day or two before, on his seventh birthday. More about this late. Suffice it to say here that Mr. Bowers was not a Catholic, though I believe had taken instructions to some extent and seemed well disposed. The mother belonged some way to the O'Brien family and, consequently, seemed to hope that we might stay for the funeral and possibly conduct it, and offer the Mass. This we consented to do--I ought to say, they arranged to do--Maurice and Edward. I wished simply to leave everything to them and passively fall in line with whatever they might wish to decide on--begging the Good God to guide them, and us all, for the best. There was quite a crowd at the Rosary recital, and I believe, quite some edified.